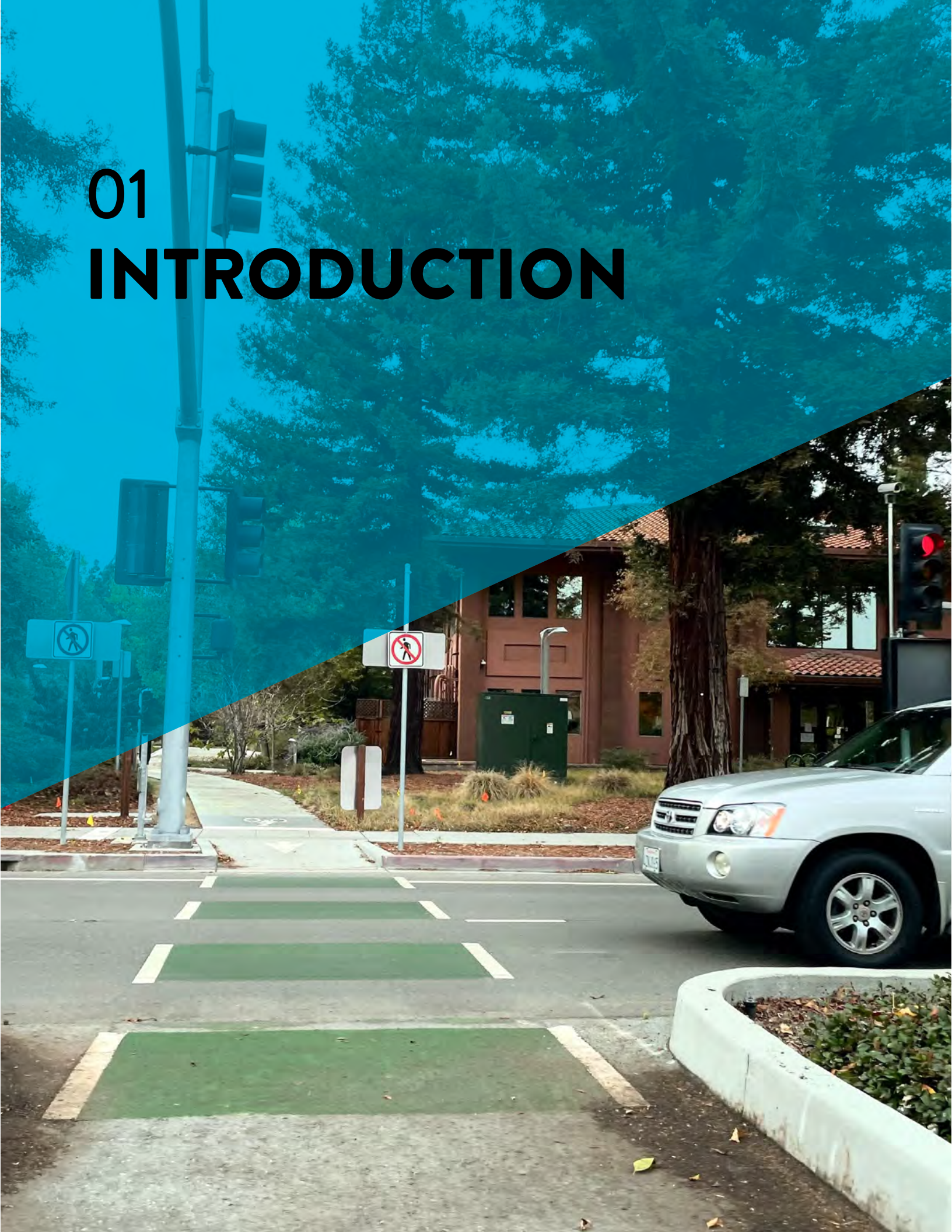


01

INTRODUCTION



What is an Active Transportation Plan?

Mountain View envisions an active transportation network that is safe and comfortable for all users regardless of age, ability, income, race, or language.

Chapter 1 outlines the multi-phase approach, summarizes public and stakeholder engagement methods, and presents the vision and guiding principles that shaped the plan's recommendations. It explains why the plan matters and how it will be used to improve active transportation throughout Mountain View.

PURPOSE AND PROCESS

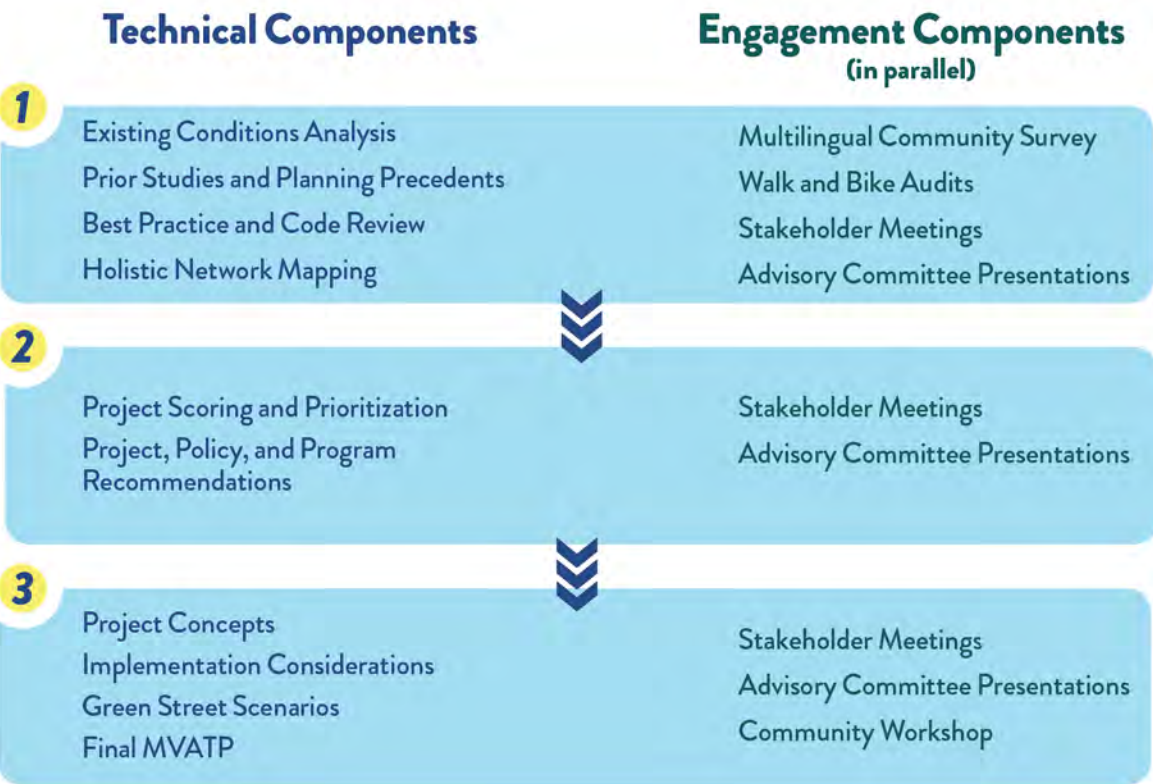
Active transportation plans use data and community input to identify the gaps and opportunities to improve the environment for walking, bicycling/scooter and rolling (including use of wheelchairs or disability-related devices). The plans typically contain recommendations for infrastructure projects, programs and policies that support active travel and an implementation plan to help recommendations move toward action. Several state and federal funding programs require projects to be identified in documents like an active transportation plan to be eligible for grants.

The Mountain View Active Transportation Plan (MVATP) reflects the active transportation experiences and priorities of people who walk, bicycle, and roll in Mountain View. Building on previous City mode-specific plans (the 2014 Pedestrian Master Plan and the 2015 Bicycle Transportation Plan), the MVATP takes a holistic look at active transportation and the coordinated solutions that support both pedestrian and bicycle travel. Several other city, regional and state-level documents and planning processes informed the development of the MVATP such as the 2020 Access MV Comprehensive Modal Plan, the 2024 Mountain View Vision Zero Action Plan, various Mountain View Precise Plans, the 2019 Environmental Sustainability Action Plan 4, the 2026 Parks and Recreation Strategic Plan, the 2026 Biodiversity and Urban Forest Plan, the 2025 Metropolitan Transportation Commission Active Transportation Plan and Complete Street Policy, and the 2024 Caltrans Strategic Highway Safety Plan, Complete Street design documents (various years), and District 4 Pedestrian (2021) and Bicycle Plans (2018).

MULTI-PHASE PROCESS

The MVATP involved three primary phases:

FIGURE 2 MVATP PROJECT PHASES



Phase 1

- ▶ Reviewed over 30 local, regional, and state planning documents related to transportation, general planning and green streets/sustainability to provide a contextual understanding of past planning recommendations and support for active transportation within Mountain View, the region and state.
- ▶ Analyzed current conditions that affect the ease, safety and comfort of people who walk, bicycle and roll in Mountain View, including physical infrastructure and complementary transportation services such as transit.
- ▶ Developed holistic active transportation network maps that identified on-street and off-street gaps and opportunities for active transportation improvements.
- ▶ Reviewed Mountain View Municipal Code focusing on those that may impact recreation, walking, and bicycling.
- ▶ Conducted a best practice review of policy and programming activities to identify resulting transportation behavior and outcomes that could be improved.

Phase 2

- ▶ Developed scoring criteria to evaluate potential physical infrastructure projects based on the MVATP guiding principles.
- ▶ Identified a list of sustainable projects based on the scoring process that improve safe, equitable and comfortable connections across the city.
- ▶ Coordinated the review of projects by stakeholders.
- ▶ Accelerated a prioritized list of physical infrastructure projects for planning level design and preliminary cost estimates.
- ▶ Developed a list of active transportation supportive policy and programming efforts based on best practice, past planning documents, and city code review.

Phase 3

- ▶ Prepared planning level design and preliminary cost estimates for seventeen projects considering near-term improvements that could be done with resurfacing and longer-term reconstruction efforts to support active transportation.
- ▶ Evaluated the short and long-term costs and benefits of green street infrastructure through a series of project development scenarios.
- ▶ Identified implementation factors such as funding sources, department and interagency collaboration, and commitment to innovation and action.

The technical phases happened in parallel with and were informed by a robust community engagement process, described in the next section.

The Role of Public and Stakeholder Engagement

Inclusive public and stakeholder participation was a critical component of the MVATP's overall development. Activities were designed to engage the diverse Mountain View community, across ages, income, language, ability and how people travel. Multi-lingual (English, Spanish, Chinese and Russian) translation and interpretation services were available for key events such as community walk tours and small group meetings. Across the three project phases, multiple methods of public outreach and engagement were used.

ADVISORY COMMITTEES

Two project-specific committees and two city-wide committees provided input at key milestones of the project:

- 1) The **Technical Advisory Committee (TAC)**, an internal project committee with representatives from departments across the city with involvement in active transportation and green streets, such as Public Works, Community Development, Community Services, Police and Fire.
- 2) The **Active Transportation Plan Advisory Committee (ATPAC)**, an external project committee whose members represent community-based organizations and public agencies working on active transportation, green streets, and issues of concern to vulnerable road users, such as Santa Clara County Public Health Department, Santa Clara Valley Transportation Authority (VTA), the Community Services Agency, Mountain View Day Worker Center, MV Mobile Home Alliance, Youth Advisory Committee, Mountain View Los Altos High School District, Silicon Valley Bicycle Coalition, and Mountain View Chamber of Commerce. ATPAC members acted as liaisons with wider community networks, helped organize and participate in many of the ATP engagement activities, and provided input on the plan development.
- 3) The **Mountain View Bicycle and Pedestrian Advisory Committee (BPAC)**, a committee appointed by City Council to represent the interests of people who walk and bicycle in the city, reviewed and provided input on ATP-related topics at BPAC meetings throughout the plan development.
- 4) The **Council Transportation Committee (CTC)**, composed of three City Council members, provided input on city-wide and regional transportation planning topics.

LIVED EXPERIENCES

Lived experiences were critical to understanding the active transportation needs and opportunities in Mountain View. These insights were captured in Phase 1 by conducting three community walk tours, two bicycle tours, hosting a community-wide mapping survey, in-person small group meetings, and review of the AskMV platform comments. These insights both confirmed and highlighted community needs.

- ▶ **Three walk tours were held to understand user experience for people who walk in Mountain View.** Walk tours began at Rengstorff Park, Mistral Elementary school, Sunset Estates Mobile Home Park. Approximately 15-25 people representing a range of ages and abilities took part in each tour, walking the streets adjacent to these community and residential locations, to better understand the walking experience of vulnerable road users.
- ▶ **Two bicycle tours were held to understand user experience bicycling in Mountain View.** Approximately 40 adults and three children participated in a three-hour-long collaborative process that covered over 11 miles of Mountain View, and focused on areas identified (in AccessMV, AskMV and survey comments) as high-stress critical connections in the bicycling network.

FIGURE 3 BICYCLE TOUR



- ▶ **An online map-based community survey was developed in spring 2023 via Maptionnaire.** The survey sought information on user experience related to walking, biking and rolling in Mountain View, including favorite places and routes, challenging spots and routes, and requested improvements. Participants digitally recorded responses on maps and provided qualitative comments and optional sociodemographic information. The survey was available in English, Spanish, Chinese, and Russian from May 15 till July 31, 2023. Six hundred fifty-five (655) people participated in the survey.
- ▶ **Small multilingual group meetings with stakeholders to discuss Maptionnaire survey questions in person, with translators present.** In-person meetings were held to connect with communities who were under-represented (relative to census demographics) in initial community survey responses. The meetings gathered input on experiences walking, biking and rolling in Mountain View.
- ▶ **The City of Mountain View maintains an online comment platform, AskMV, where people share feedback on various topics.** City staff monitors the platform for comments regarding walking and bicycling, and transportation safety. Approximately three years of feedback was gleaned to identify frequent concerns.

These engagement methods were designed to reach communities often under-represented in planning processes, meeting people where they live and travel and in the languages they speak. The input gathered served as a project scoring criterion, with locations receiving the most comments scoring higher. The scoring process also prioritized projects in low- and mid-income census tracts and projects that close gaps in the sidewalk and all ages and abilities bicycle networks.



FIGURE 4 MULTI-LINGUAL MVATP SURVEY PROMOTION (LEFT)

FIGURE 5 WALK TOUR (BELOW)



PUBLIC WORKSHOPS, POP-UPS, AND COMMENT PERIODS

Pop-ups, workshops and comments during community events and public meetings were used as opportunities to gather additional feedback on MVATP findings and recommendations.

PUBLIC OFFICIAL ENGAGEMENT

Presentations to BPAC, CTC, and City Council were conducted at project milestones, including existing conditions, scoring criteria, holistic maps, final recommendations, the draft as well as final plan.

FIGURE 6 MISTRAL WALK TOUR PARTICIPANT NOTES

ACTIVE TRANSPORTATION PLAN City of Mountain View

Your information (optional)
Name: _____
Email: _____
Neighborhood: *Bubb! Quarta*

OVERALL NEIGHBORHOOD EXPERIENCE

Quality and safety of Sidewalks: *Some are safe because they are wide, but some are narrow and feel not safe*

Quality and safety of Street Crossings: *Escuela Ave and Latham St (school morning time, dismissal)*

Quality and safety of driver behavior: _____

Feeling of safety in the area: _____

Comfort and appeal of the area: _____

Additional Comments: *Thank you for doing this event. It means a lot for my children as well to think about how we can walk safely, and what should we have to be careful. We love this city and people. Thank you so much for your support!*

ACTIVE TRANSPORTATION PLAN The City of Mountain View is working on an Active Transportation Plan to improve walking, rolling, and biking for everyone in the city. Please walk with us and show us exactly what is working and not working in your community.

WALK TOUR NOTES

9:30-11:00 AM, 12 August 2023

Your observations en route: *I can see trees to make shade for our way. It was harder for us to walk when there were lots of cars.*

I Had fun today

I like how there is shade for our way

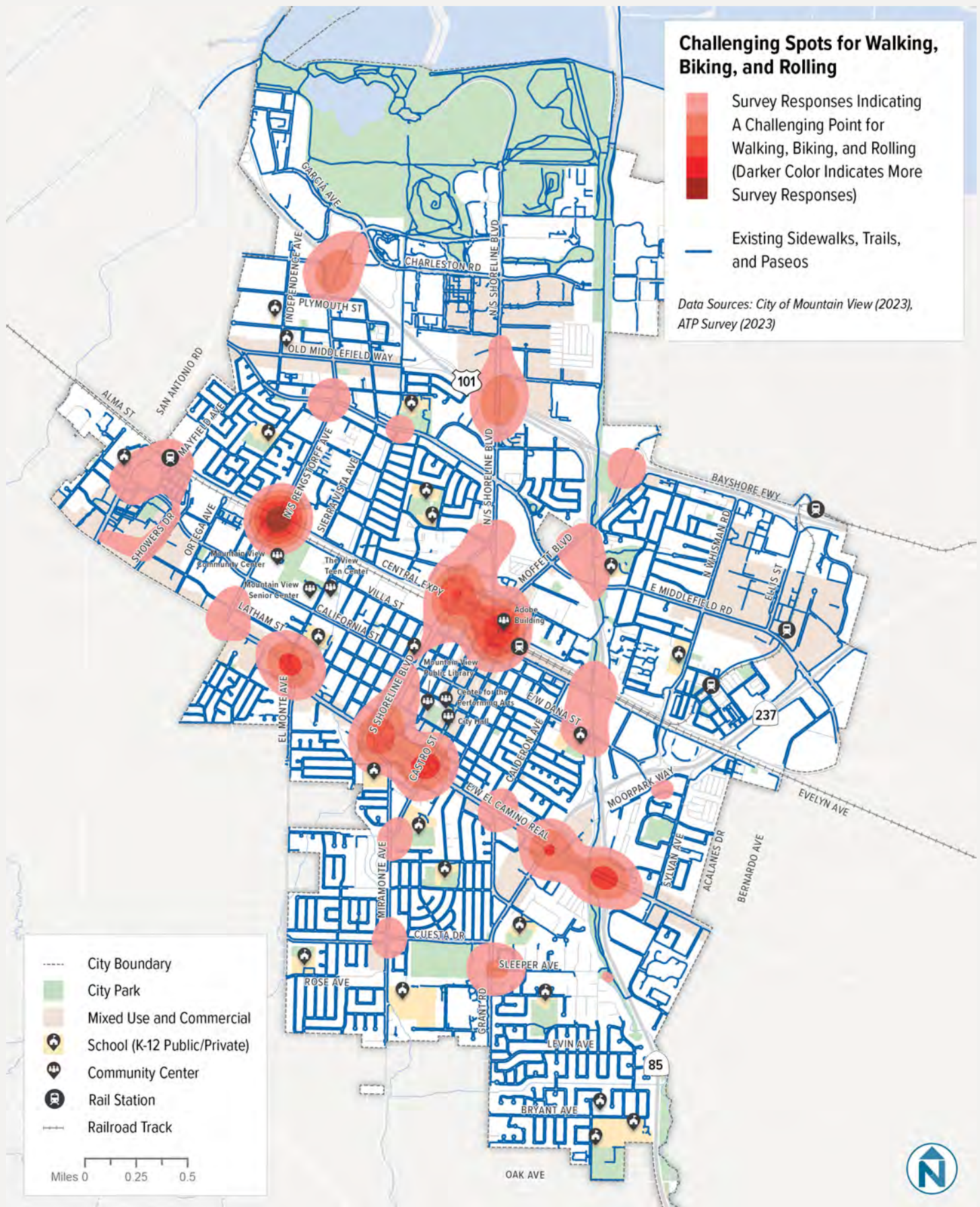
I Had fun walking

It was also hard for me to walk with all those things in my way. But were fun today. It was hot but trees made shade so I was ok.

West El Camino Blvd

S. Bascom Ave

FIGURE 7 COMMUNITY COMMENTS ON CHALLENGING PLACES



Note: a Key Locations table can be found in Chapter 2.

VISION & GUIDING PRINCIPLES OF THE MVATP

With input from the ATPAC, TAC, and BPAC, a Vision Statement and Guiding Principles were developed that reflected the goals, purpose and values of the MVATP. The Vision Statement and Guiding Principles were reviewed and approved by City Council.

Vision Statement:

*Mountain View leads the region with an Active Transportation Plan that **defines a series of connected, low-stress, and green corridors that invite active transportation.** The corridors include shade, wildlife habitat, and public open spaces. The plan enables the City to intentionally support a culture of walking and biking, enhance biodiversity, and reduce climate change impacts.*



Guiding Principles

The guiding principles describe key outcomes and act as a framework that the project team can refer to throughout the planning process to ensure efficient, strategic, and accountable decision-making.

- **Mobility & Connectivity**
Streets that are easy to use and well-connected for walking, biking, and rolling purposes.
- **Safety & Comfort**
Trails, sidewalks, bikeways, intersections, and crosswalks that are safe, inviting, and easy to use.
- **Access & Equity**
Policies and programs that engage and protect vulnerable populations and increase mobility choices.
- **Sustainability & Biodiversity**
Green streets that improve access to nature and open spaces while promoting sustainability via native habitats and stormwater management.
- **Innovation & Action-Oriented**
An implementable plan with clear standards that are updated and aligned with adopted policies.

Why Does This Plan Matter and How Will It Be Used?

Achieving a future that supports sustainable active transportation for all in Mountain View requires a holistic approach and commitment to action. Through the development of an Active Transportation Plan, the City of Mountain View took an important step forward.

The MVATP helps the public and decision makers understand the importance of active transportation for community mobility, livability, health, and sustainability and its vision for it based on Mountain View values. The MVATP identifies a host of actions to create a truly active transportation system for Mountain View residents and visitors. The MVATP actions complement related actions in other city planning efforts, including the City's Vision Zero Action Plan, Biodiversity and Urban Forest Plan, and Parks and Recreation Strategic Plan. Through these actions, the MVATP documents the community's commitment to active transportation through policy, programming and infrastructure, laying the groundwork for financial and organizational support for active transportation projects.

In addition, the MVATP informs future Capital Improvement Programs (CIPs), helping prioritize investments in active transportation projects. It also serves as guidance for private development along priority corridors, encouraging alignment with planned improvements without establishing strict requirements. This plan will help guide collaborations with Caltrans, Santa Clara County, and VTA, all of which own and operate major transportation facilities within Mountain View.

FIGURE 8 DOWNTOWN MOUNTAIN VIEW STREETSCAPE



FIGURE 9 COMMUNITY QUOTES
FROM MAPTIONNAIRE SURVEY

“We cannot achieve our climate, pollution, and health goals without replacing some individual car trips with active or shared transportation. Plus, we’ve got the best climate in the world!”

“Mountain View has the potential to create an active transit Mecca given its size (5 miles) and amenities. It will sustain us through economic highs and lows because people want to live where they can walk whether they know it or not.”

“Every bicyclist on a trail is one fewer car on the road, so while the infrastructure may be expensive, it provides a benefit to all Mountain View residents and not only the ones who use it.”

“Mountain View should think about this as a goal: ‘Active Transportation should be the preferred method of travel in Mountain View.’ Think about how it would change our street and sidewalk design decisions if we at least asked ourselves that question every time a streetscape design decision is made.”
